Gold, dollars and debt.

How the world's biggest economies save, borrow and fund.

8,134 t
Gold held by the US, a third of all G20 official gold.

$3.7tn
China's total reserves, the world's largest. Less than a tenth is gold.

27×
What the US government owes, compared with the reserves it holds.

124%
US debt as a share of its economy, growing about $2tn a year.

Data: World Gold Council, IMF

Swipe →

The US holds a third of the G20's official gold, worth about $1.2 trillion.

Gold held by each G20 central bank, in tonnes and in US dollars.

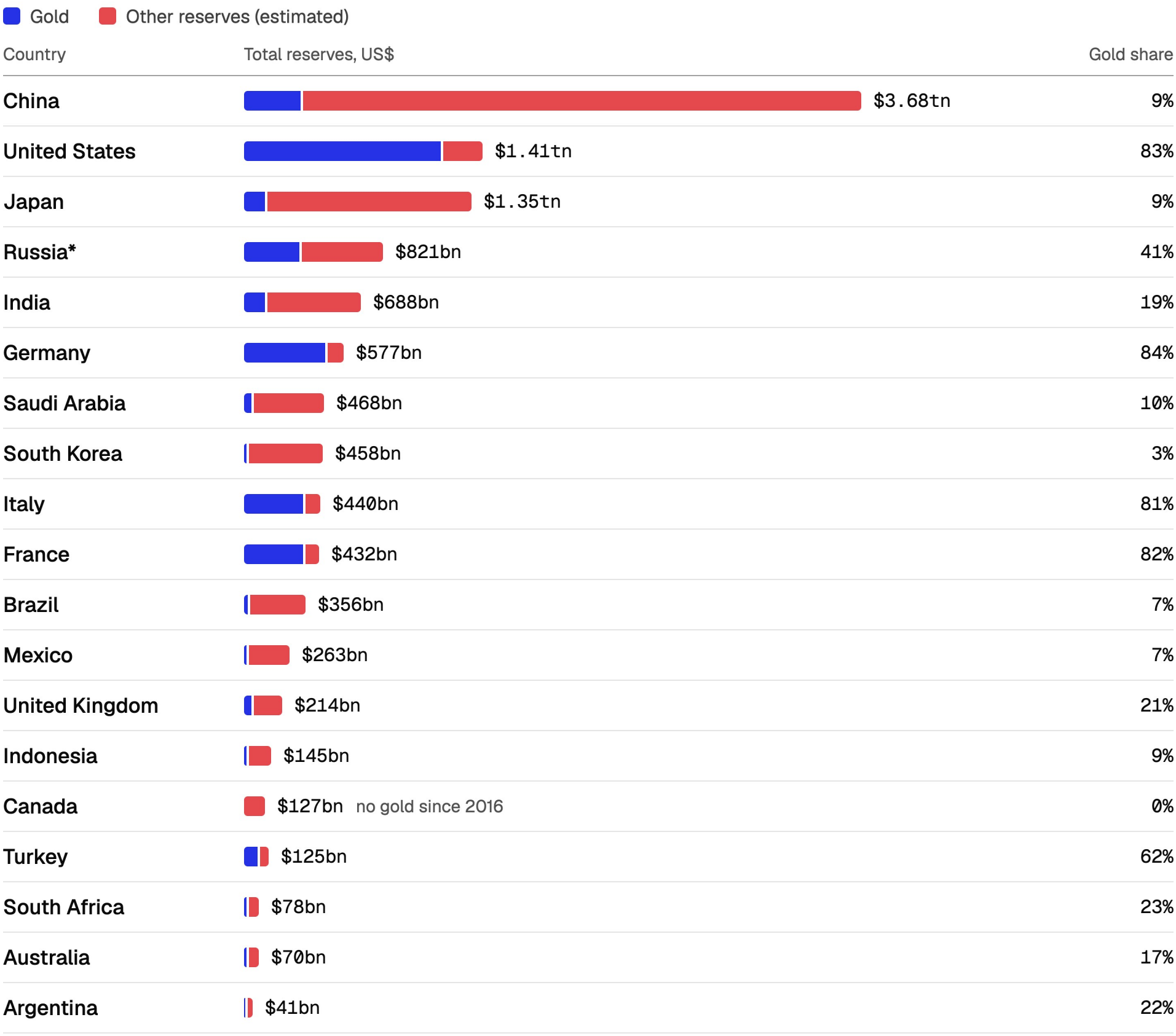
Country	Official gold, tonnes	Value, US$
United States	8,134 t	$1.18tn
Germany	3,350 t	$485bn
Italy	2,452 t	$355bn
France	2,437 t	$353bn
China	2,313 t	$335bn
Russia	2,305 t	$333bn
India	880 t	$127bn
Japan	846 t	$122bn
Turkey	535 t	$77bn
Saudi Arabia	323 t	$47bn
United Kingdom	310 t	$45bn
Brazil	172 t	$25bn
South Africa	126 t	$18bn
Mexico	120 t	$17bn
South Korea	104 t	$15bn
Indonesia	87 t	$13bn
Australia	80 t	$12bn
Argentina	62 t	$9bn
Canada	0 t sold its last gold in 2016	$0bn

G20 central banks hold about **24,600** tonnes, two-thirds of all official gold. The IMF holds another **2,814**.

Source: World Gold Council, official gold holdings as of 5 May 2026. Valued at about $4,500 per ounce, the price when these holdings were reported; values move with the gold price. The G20 also includes the EU and African Union.

China holds $3.7 trillion in reserves. Less than a tenth of it is gold.

Estimated central bank reserves of each G20 country, split into gold and everything else, mainly foreign government bonds and deposits.



Country	Total reserves, US$	Gold share
China	$3.68tn	9%
United States	$1.41tn	83%
Japan	$1.35tn	9%
Russia*	$821bn	41%
India	$688bn	19%
Germany	$577bn	84%
Saudi Arabia	$468bn	10%
South Korea	$458bn	3%
Italy	$440bn	81%
France	$432bn	82%
Brazil	$356bn	7%
Mexico	$263bn	7%
United Kingdom	$214bn	21%
Indonesia	$145bn	9%
Canada	$127bn no gold since 2016	0%
Turkey	$125bn	62%
South Africa	$78bn	23%
Australia	$70bn	17%
Argentina	$41bn	22%

Foreign central banks hold about **$3.9tn** of US Treasuries, roughly 30% of the world's **$13.2tn** in currency reserves.

*Russia's figure includes roughly $300bn frozen in the West. Sources: World Gold Council official holdings and gold share of reserves, 5 May 2026; gold at about $4,500/oz. Other reserves estimated as total reserves (gold value ÷ gold share) minus gold; Canada from official data, Aug 2026. Treasuries: US Treasury TIC data; reserves total: IMF COFER, Q2 2026.

The US owes 27 times its reserves. Saudi Arabia and Russia hold more than they owe.

Government debt and central bank reserves in US dollars, largest debt first.

Country	Government debt	Reserves	Debt ÷ reserves
United States	$38.1tn	$1.4tn	27×
China	$19.5tn	$3.7tn	5.3×
Japan	$9.2tn	$1.3tn	6.8×
United Kingdom	$4.1tn	$214bn	19×
France	$3.9tn	$431bn	9.1×
Italy	$3.5tn	$440bn	8.0×
India	$3.3tn	$689bn	4.8×
Germany	$3.2tn	$577bn	5.5×
Canada	$2.6tn	$127bn	21×
Brazil	$2.1tn	$356bn	6.0×
Mexico	$1.1tn	$263bn	4.3×
South Korea	$980bn	$458bn	2.1×
Australia	$940bn	$69bn	14×
Indonesia	$590bn	$145bn	4.1×
Argentina	$550bn	$41bn	13×
Russia*	$450bn	$821bn	0.5×
Saudi Arabia	$400bn	$468bn	0.9×
Turkey	$380bn	$126bn	3.0×
South Africa	$340bn	$78bn	4.4×

Reserves aren't meant to repay this debt. Rich countries mostly borrow in their own currency. The comparison matters most where debt is owed in someone else's currency.

*Includes about $300bn frozen in the West; Russia still holds more than it owes without it. Debt: IMF Fiscal Monitor, April 2026, general government gross debt (% of GDP, 2025) × IMF 2025 GDP. Reserves: World Gold Council gold holdings and share of reserves, May 2026, gold at about $4,500/oz; Canada from official data. All figures approximate.

The US owes more than a year of its entire output, and adds about $2 trillion a year.

Government debt against each economy's annual output (GDP), in US dollars, largest economy first, with the yearly deficit: how fast the debt is growing.

Country	GDP (a year's output) / Government debt	Debt, % of GDP	Deficit, % of GDP
United States	$30.8tn / $38.1tn	**124%**	**6.8%**
China	$19.6tn / $19.5tn	99%	**7.9%**
Germany	$5.0tn / $3.2tn	63%	2.7%
Japan	$4.4tn / $9.2tn	**206%**	1.1%
United Kingdom	$4.0tn / $4.1tn	**102%**	5.4%
India	$3.9tn / $3.3tn	84%	**7.4%**
France	$3.4tn / $3.9tn	**116%**	5.1%
Russia	$2.6tn / $445bn	17%	3.9%
Italy	$2.5tn / $3.5tn	**137%**	3.1%
Canada	$2.3tn / $2.6tn	**114%**	1.8%
Brazil	$2.3tn / $2.1tn	93%	**8.1%**
South Korea	$1.9tn / $978bn	52%	1.4%
Australia	$1.8tn / $938bn	51%	2.8%
Mexico	$1.8tn / $1.1tn	62%	4.9%
Turkey	$1.6tn / $376bn	24%	2.8%
Indonesia	$1.4tn / $594bn	41%	2.9%
Saudi Arabia	$1.3tn / $406bn	32%	5.8%
Argentina	$680bn / $546bn	80%	0.4%
South Africa	$430bn / $338bn	79%	5.8%

In household terms: GDP is the family's total earning power, debt is the mortgage, and the deficit is how much more it spends than it takes in each year. At current deficits the US adds about **$2.1tn** of debt a year and China about **$1.6tn**.

Deficits of 6% of GDP or more in bold red. Sources: IMF Fiscal Monitor, April 2026 (general government gross debt and overall deficit, 2025); IMF World Economic Outlook, April 2026 (GDP 2025, current US$). Debt in dollars = debt ratio × GDP, so approximate. Gross debt ignores government assets: Canada's net debt is about 10% of GDP.